



VANGUARD STEM ACADEMY

2027 Admissions & Placement Application

Students | College Students | Adult Learners | Working Professionals

Vanguard STEM Academy provides immersive, project-based learning experiences in STEM, Artificial Intelligence, Business Intelligence, Consulting, Leadership, and Innovation. Please complete every applicable section thoroughly and honestly. Incomplete applications may delay review.

STEP 1 — APPLICANT INFORMATION

Program Selection

- | | |
|---|--|
| ☐ Youth STEM Academy | ☐ Business Intelligence Academy |
| ☐ AI Innovation Academy | ☐ Executive Mentorship |
| ☐ International Consulting Academy | |

International Consulting Project Preference

Complete only when applying to the International Consulting Academy.

- ☐ Ocean Bricks Luxury Marina Consulting Project
☐ K-12 Curriculum Innovation Consulting Project
☐ No Preference — assign me based on program needs

Delivery Format

- | | | |
|--------------------------------------|---------------------------------|--|
| ☐ Live Cohort | ☐ Hybrid | ☐ On-Demand Learning (when available) |
|--------------------------------------|---------------------------------|--|

Applicant Type

- | | |
|--|---|
| ☐ High School Student | ☐ College Student |
| ☐ Adult Learner | ☐ Working Professional |

Personal Information

First Name

Last Name

Date of Birth

Mobile Phone

Street Address

Middle Initial

Preferred Name (optional)

Email Address

Home Phone (optional)

City



State

Country

ZIP Code

Emergency Contact

Full Name

Phone Number

Relationship

Email Address

Parent/Guardian Information

Required for applicants under age 18.

Parent/Guardian Name

Email Address

Relationship

Phone Number

Education / Employment Information

Current School or Employer

Expected Graduation Date (if applicable)

Current Major or Career Field

Website / Portfolio (optional)

Current Grade Level or Job Title

Current GPA (students only)

LinkedIn Profile (optional)

STEP 2 — PROGRAM READINESS ASSESSMENT

This section helps Vanguard determine the most appropriate placement level and learning pathway.

Technical Experience

Which areas have you explored? Select all that apply.

- | | | |
|--|--|--|
| ☐ Artificial Intelligence | ☐ Business Intelligence | ☐ Data Analytics |
| ☐ Programming | ☐ Robotics | ☐ Engineering |
| ☐ Mathematics | ☐ Cybersecurity | ☐ Product Design |
| ☐ Entrepreneurship | ☐ Leadership | ☐ Public Speaking |
| ☐ Research | ☐ Consulting | ☐ None of the Above |

Programming Experience

Have you ever written computer code? ☐ Yes ☐ No

If yes, select all languages used:

- | | | | |
|-----------------------------------|----------------------------------|-------------------------------|---------------------------------------|
| ☐ Python | ☐ SQL | ☐ Java | ☐ JavaScript |
| ☐ HTML/CSS | ☐ Scratch | ☐ C++ | ☐ Other: _____ |

Software & Technology Experience

- | | | |
|--|---------------------------------------|--|
| ☐ Microsoft Excel | ☐ Power BI | ☐ Tableau |
| ☐ Google Sheets | ☐ VS Code | ☐ Replit |
| ☐ Google Colab | ☐ GitHub | ☐ ChatGPT |
| ☐ Claude | ☐ Gemini | ☐ Microsoft Copilot |
| ☐ Perplexity AI | ☐ Other: _____ | |

Technology Readiness

- | | |
|---|--|
| ☐ Reliable laptop or desktop: Yes | ☐ Reliable laptop or desktop: No |
| ☐ Reliable internet: Yes | ☐ Reliable internet: No |
| ☐ Comfortable installing software: Yes | ☐ Comfortable installing software: No |
| ☐ May need installation assistance | |

Self-Assessment

For each area, select one: Beginner / Developing / Comfortable / Advanced.

Skill	Beginner	Developing	Comfortable	Advanced
Learning New Technical Skills	☐	☐	☐	☐
Working Independently	☐	☐	☐	☐
Team Collaboration	☐	☐	☐	☐
Communication Skills	☐	☐	☐	☐
Problem Solving	☐	☐	☐	☐
Time Management	☐	☐	☐	☐



Career Interests

- | | | |
|--|---|--|
| ☐ Artificial Intelligence | ☐ Data Science | ☐ Business Intelligence |
| ☐ Software Engineering | ☐ Mechanical Engineering | ☐ Biomedical Engineering |
| ☐ Robotics | ☐ Product Management | ☐ Consulting |
| ☐ Entrepreneurship | ☐ Finance | ☐ Project Management |
| ☐ Research | ☐ Education | ☐ Government/Public Service |
| ☐ Healthcare | ☐ Undecided | |

Why Vanguard? In one or two sentences, what interests you most about Vanguard STEM Academy?



STEP 3 — PERSONAL STATEMENT

Required for all applicants. Answer thoughtfully and concisely.

1. What attracted you to Vanguard, and why is this the right program for you?

2. How does your chosen academy align with your interests, career goals, or future aspirations?

3. Where do you see yourself in the next 5–10 years, and how will Vanguard help you get there?

4. Describe a personal, academic, or professional challenge and what you learned from it.

5. What project, accomplishment, or experience are you most proud of?

6. If you could solve one problem in your school, community, workplace, or the world, what would it be and why?

7. Why should Vanguard select you? What strengths, qualities, or experiences will you bring to the cohort?

**STEP 3B — ACADEMY-SPECIFIC QUESTIONS**

Complete only the section for the academy selected in Step 1.

AI Innovation Academy

1. Have you used Artificial Intelligence tools before? ☐ Yes ☐ No

☐ ChatGPT

☐ Claude

☐ Gemini

☐ Copilot

☐ Perplexity

☐ Other: _____

2. Have you ever written computer code? ☐ Yes ☐ No

3. What interests you most about Artificial Intelligence?

4. What AI-related project would you like to build during this program?

Business Intelligence Academy

1. Have you worked with data before? ☐ Yes ☐ No

☐ Excel

☐ SQL

☐ Tableau

☐ Power BI

☐ Python

☐ Google Sheets

2. Why are you interested in Business Intelligence?

3. What business or organizational problem would you like to solve using data?

Executive Mentorship

1. Why are you interested in leadership development?

2. Describe a leadership experience you have had.

3. Which professional skills would you most like to improve?

☐ Communication

☐ Public Speaking

☐ Networking

☐ Leadership

☐ Interviewing

☐ Career Planning

☐ Executive Presence

☐ Other: _____

**STEP 3B — ACADEMY-SPECIFIC QUESTIONS (CONTINUED)****International Consulting Academy**

Which topics interest you most? Select all that apply.

- | | | |
|--|---|---|
| ☐ Engineering Design | ☐ Systems Thinking | ☐ Human-Centered Design |
| ☐ Stakeholder Engagement | ☐ Stakeholder Management | ☐ Business Analysis |
| ☐ Project Management | ☐ Product Development | ☐ Strategic Planning |
| ☐ Innovation Strategy | ☐ Research & Analysis | ☐ Data Analysis |
| ☐ Client Presentations | ☐ Team Leadership | ☐ Cross-Functional Collaboration |
| ☐ Professional Consulting | | |

Why are you interested in consulting?

Which consulting experience interests you most?

- ☐ Ocean Bricks Luxury Marina Consulting Project
- ☐ K-12 Curriculum Innovation Consulting Project
- ☐ Either Project

Why?

Describe a time you worked with a team to solve a difficult problem.

How comfortable are you presenting ideas to clients or large groups?

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ Very Comfortable | ☐ Comfortable |
| ☐ Somewhat Comfortable | ☐ I would like to improve this skill |

Youth STEM Academy

1. Which STEM areas interest you most?

- | | | |
|--|-------------------------------------|---|
| ☐ Analytics | ☐ Technology | ☐ Engineering Design |
| ☐ Collaboration | ☐ Research | ☐ Projects |

2. Why do you enjoy STEM?

3. What invention or innovation would you like to create one day?

Applicant Verification

- ☐ I have answered all required questions.
- ☐ I understand that my responses will be used in Vanguard STEM Academy's admissions and placement review.

**STEP 4 — TUITION, SCHOLARSHIP & REQUIRED DOCUMENTS**

Scholarships may be available to qualified applicants depending on funding. Applying for financial assistance does not guarantee an award.

Tuition Payment Method

- ☐ I will pay tuition myself.
- ☐ I am requesting need-based financial assistance.
- ☐ My employer will sponsor my tuition.
- ☐ My school district will sponsor my tuition.
- ☐ Another organization will sponsor my tuition.

Scholarship Information

Complete only when requesting financial assistance.

Annual Household Income (\$)**Number of People in Household**

Are you currently receiving any of the following?

- | | | |
|--|--|-------------------------------------|
| ☐ Free or Reduced Lunch | ☐ SNAP Benefits | ☐ Medicaid |
| ☐ SSI | ☐ TANF | ☐ Pell Grant |
| ☐ None of the Above | | |

Briefly explain why you are requesting financial assistance.

Required Financial Documentation

Submit at least one primary income document:

- ☐ Most Recent Federal Tax Return (parent/guardian if under 18)
- ☐ W-2 Form(s)
- ☐ 1099 Form(s)

Optional supporting documentation:

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☐ Free/Reduced Lunch Verification | ☐ SNAP Benefits Letter |
| ☐ Medicaid Documentation | ☐ SSI Documentation |
| ☐ Employer Income Verification | ☐ Other Financial Documentation |

Scholarship Certification

- ☐ I understand that scholarship review will not begin until all required financial documentation is received.
- ☐ I understand Vanguard may request additional documentation to verify financial need.
- ☐ I certify that all financial information submitted is accurate to the best of my knowledge.



Required Application Documents

- ☐ Resume (college students and professionals)
- ☐ Transcript or most recent report card (students)
- ☐ Portfolio (if applicable)

Optional supporting documents:

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ Letter of Recommendation | ☐ Personal Portfolio |
| ☐ LinkedIn Profile | ☐ Certifications |
| ☐ Other Supporting Documents | |



STEP 5 — PROGRAM COMMITMENT & AGREEMENTS

Vanguard STEM Academy is an intensive academic and professional development program designed to reflect real-world industry expectations.

Attendance Commitment

For the Fall 2026 AI Foundations & Emerging Technologies Cohort:

- ☐ Tuesday classes: 5:30 PM–8:00 PM ET
- ☐ Thursday classes: 5:30 PM–8:00 PM ET
- ☐ Professional Development Saturday approximately every other week; dates announced in advance
- ☐ I understand the required schedule and confirm I am available for all sessions.
- ☐ I understand attendance is mandatory and excessive absences, repeated tardiness, or leaving early may result in probation or dismissal.
- ☐ I understand attendance is monitored and considered in successful program completion.

Weekly Time Commitment

Expect approximately 9–11 hours per week, including live instruction, independent assignments, research, team meetings, consulting work, presentation preparation, mentor meetings, and capstone development.

- ☐ I can commit approximately 9–11 hours each week.
- ☐ I understand that consistent participation is required throughout the cohort.

Assignment Expectations

- ☐ Assignments must be submitted by established deadlines.
- ☐ Repeated late or missing work may affect my standing.
- ☐ I will actively participate in every class session.
- ☐ Quitting a team project or failing to contribute may result in removal.

Professional Conduct & Collaboration

- ☐ Treat instructors, mentors, guest speakers, partners, and students with professionalism and respect.
- ☐ Contribute fairly to team assignments and consulting projects.
- ☐ Communicate professionally in meetings, email, chat platforms, and presentations.
- ☐ Uphold Vanguard standards of integrity, accountability, and collaboration.
- ☐ Refrain from plagiarism, cheating, falsifying work, harassment, discrimination, or disruptive behavior.
- ☐ Understand that policy violations may result in discipline or dismissal.

**STEP 5 — PROGRAM COMMITMENT & AGREEMENTS (CONTINUED)****Technology Commitment**

- ☐ I have reliable internet access.
- ☐ I have consistent access to a laptop or desktop computer.
- ☐ I am willing to install required software and learn new technologies.

Transportation Responsibility

Some activities may occur in person, including industry visits, consulting engagements, networking events, guest speakers, Demo Day, graduation, and partner meetings.

- ☐ I am responsible for reliable transportation to all required in-person activities.
- ☐ I understand lateness or absence from required in-person events may affect my participation and standing.

Real-World Learning Acknowledgment

Participants may work on AI projects, Business Intelligence initiatives, engineering design challenges, international consulting engagements, product development, community innovation, client presentations, and cross-functional team projects.

- ☐ I understand I will be expected to perform professionally by meeting deadlines, communicating effectively, collaborating with teammates, and representing Vanguard with integrity.

Applicant Certification

- ☐ The information in this application is true, accurate, and complete to the best of my knowledge.
- ☐ False or misleading information may result in denial of admission or removal from the program.
- ☐ Submitting this application does not guarantee admission or scholarship funding.
- ☐ I authorize Vanguard to verify academic, educational, employment, or financial information when necessary.
- ☐ I agree to comply with Vanguard policies, attendance requirements, academic standards, and Code of Conduct.
- ☐ Vanguard may dismiss participants who fail to meet academic, attendance, behavioral, or professional expectations.
- ☐ Schedules, instructors, projects, guest speakers, and activities may change for educational or operational needs.
- ☐ Photos, videos, or recordings may be used for educational and promotional purposes unless a written media opt-out is submitted by me or my parent/guardian if I am under 18.

Signature**Applicant Name**

Signature

Date



Parent/Guardian Signature

Required when the applicant is under 18.

Parent/Guardian Name

Parent/Guardian Signature

Date
